



Developing Your Brand

A brand is a tool for helping a business stand out from the crowd. Creating and refining your own brand will enable you to inform customers what your business is about—and what sets it apart.

Creating a brand

Your brand is more than just a logo or design used for advertising. It is a means of communicating your company's purpose and values to your customers.

Imagine, for example, that a start-up develops a new fruit drink made only from organic ingredients.

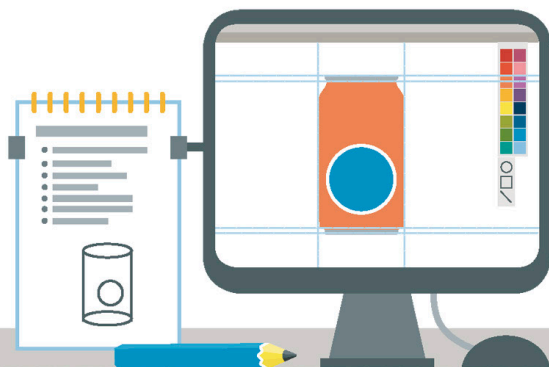
In order to attract sales, the owners might promote the idea that the product is sustainable, ethical, and healthy. By building these values into their brand, the start-up owners can convey the benefits of their product to customers. In addition to its values, the brand might also embody a

particular personality, such as a spirited or youthful outlook (see below).

You must be consistent and authentic, however. For instance, if customers discover that the drink contains artificial ingredients or is sourced unethically, they may lose faith in your brand.

Deciding on your brand

Consider what your customers are looking for, what you are offering, and what your company stands for. Ensure that these align. Your brand is about conveying your values, such as being ethical, along with your "personality," which is the public perception of your company's character.



Developing the concept

Consider the benefits that your customers derive from your products or services. Then decide what ideas you would like customers to associate with your brand. This could be notions such as "traditional and reliable," "sophisticated and exclusive," "rugged," or "bold."



Choosing your brand personality

Your brand's personality is the human characteristics that you would like to be linked to your brand. So, if your target audience is involved with sports, for example, you might want your brand's personality to embody energy and vibrancy.